

L2 - 1.1. Senior Security Analyst Intro

Task 1 - Journey to Senior

This room serves as a roadmap for getting there: the technical skills, the broader toolkit, and the new challenges and responsibilities to expect. You'll also learn how to develop a senior mindset and prepare for even more advanced roles.

Task 2 - New Role, New Duties

The Level 2 analyst is a natural progression from Level 1: a middle- or senior-level technical role responsible for investigating escalated alerts and responding to threats. As Level 2, you are expected to excel at log analysis and take over basic engineering and incident response tasks. In addition, you should have strong soft skills to mentor juniors, take initiative, and properly communicate with different teams.

New Tasks and Duties

- Build new detection rules and run threat hunting exercises
- Cooperate with the IT team to configure the network securely
- Respond to infections: clean malware and rotate credentials
- Participate in, or even lead IR in case of a major intrusion
- And, of course, triage complex alerts escalated by Level 1

Answer the questions below

| Should you improve tech, soft, or both skills to become L2?

Both

Task 3 - Fun of Being SOC L2

Incident Handling

- Learn how to respond to attacks using EDR or a regular CLI
- See the world beyond SIEM: host, cloud, and network points of view
- Observe the same attacks you read about in threat reports and blogs

Engineering Tasks

- Simulate an attack and build a detection rule to cover it
- Dig deeper into how SIEMs and EDRs work internally
- Automate a routine task and make your team's life easier

General Security Tasks

- Learn about corporate processes and the daily life of other departments, especially IT
- Discover enterprise software such as SAP, Salesforce, Jira, Stripe, and the M365 suite
- Explore new security domains: pentesting, compliance, DevOps, AppSec, and more

Answer the questions below

| Does exploring new security areas help you grow? (Yea/Nay)

Yea

Task 4 - L1 vs L2 Mindset Shift

Sense of Responsibility: Level 2 isn't just a technical step up, it's a mindset shift. As a senior, you take responsibility for your team and for the security posture of the whole organization. You can't say "it's not my fault" after a ransomware attack, because everyone now expects ownership from you, not excuses. And the first rule of the senior mindset is simple: never ignore a security concern, whether it was raised by you or someone else.

Attacker Mindset: It is recommended that L2 have some red teaming experience because the more you understand how attacks occur, the easier it is to understand the adversary's behavior and predict their next steps. Combined with

knowledge of MITRE and the Cyber Kill Chain, the attacker's mindset will help you read between the lines and run your investigations much more quickly and in a more organized way.

Answer the questions below

What mindset helps you see and predict how incidents unfold?

Attacker Mindset

Task 5 - Your Day as Level 2

Challenge: Open the static site by clicking the **View Site** button below. You will start from a SIEM interface and go through a daily routine of the L2 analyst: triage of escalated alerts, rule development and tuning, and responding to urgent threats. Follow the instructions in the app and get your flag.

Answer the questions below

What flag did you get after completing the challenge?

THM{much_more_than_alert_triage}

Task 6 - Next Steps

#	Goal	Suggestions
1	Gain SOC technical skills	• Complete the <u>SOC Level 2 Analyst</u> path • Try yourself in different blue challenges • Monitor how L2 in your company operate
2	Build up attacker's mindset	• Complete rooms from the <u>Red Teaming</u> path • Analyze historical incidents your company faced • Read cyber news, especially technical threat reports
3	Broaden security awareness	• Discover how other teams in your company work • Volunteer for an engineering task (e.g., fix a rule)

#	Goal	Suggestions
		• Ask to be involved in the Incident Response tasks
4	Validate acquired skills	• Consider passing a practical SOC or IR certification • For example, check out TryHackMe's SAL2 certification (Evaluates both hard and soft skills across 12 domains)